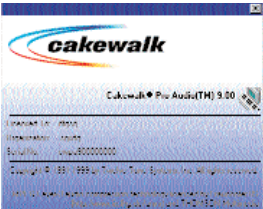


SOUND EDITING (MIDI)

Sound editing software have been around for a while now but they've never been so easy to use and so full of features. With intuitive interfaces and more and more improvements incorporated in these software, home users and novices can get their musical fingers dancing on the features that were formerly available only at high-end music studios. Also, the processing power available on today's computers provides plenty of headroom to produce some very powerful and professional-sounding effects. With the advent of seriously powerful processors on sound-cards, it will only become so much more easy to create rich-sounding audio tracks and produce home recordings. This increased power in the audio hardware will also be responsible for allowing more powerful audio effects and features to be implemented in audio sequencing software, be it hundreds of streams of audio data being handled simultaneously, advanced digital effects such as dynamic pitch bending, or multi-channel audio. The best thing of all is that audio editing tasks will be possible in real time.



Cakewalk Pro Audio 9



*Good features and an easy-to-use interface make this the perfect choice for MIDI sequencing*

One of the *de facto* standards in MIDI sequencing, Cakewalk Pro Audio 9 raises the bar when it comes to the features and advanced tools for working with MIDI files. Especially impressive is the ability to work with different views, which simplifies working with large and complex multi-track files, its audio effects and its ability to save as MP3. An intuitive and feature-rich interface makes this software the application of choice for professional as well as amateur users when it comes to MIDI sequencing applications.

- + Rich in features
- + Easy-to-use and intuitive interface

**Price:** Not available  
**Web site:** [www.cakewalk.com](http://www.cakewalk.com)

Worthy Mentions

Cubase VST 5

- + Good features
- + Good plugin support
- Price:** Not available
- Web site:** [www.steinberg.net](http://www.steinberg.net)

Evolution Audio

- + Onscreen keyboard
- + Small install size
- Price:** Not available
- Web site:** [www.evolution.co.uk](http://www.evolution.co.uk)

**PREVIOUS WINNERS** 2000: NA 1999: NA 1998: NA

SOUND EDITING (WAVE)

With MP3 being as widespread as it is, there are numerous users who would like to create audio compositions and then transfer them onto CD or to the Internet. Wave editing is one of the most demanding audio applications since they stress the system memory as well as the processing subsystems. With the ability to work with large audio files, Wave editing software can also be used to exercise a number of audio editing features on your tracks such noise removal, equalisation, echo, reverb, etc.

With future releases of these software, we will see even more features integrated into the application such as CD burning and ripping, format conversion and more streamlined use of resources. This is also going to be largely driven by the enhancement of subsystem performance such as faster processors, soundcards and hard disk drives. Interfaces and controls to these software are going to be so reflective of actual studio systems that the transition from console-based sound editing to editing on computers is going to be very natural.



Soundforge 5



*A very good set of integrated features such as CD burning and audio ripping help this software surge ahead of others in performance and features*

Soundforge 5 provides you with an easy-to-use interface, which even a novice user can get along with quickly. The software also includes some great plugins and also provides support for downloading additional plugins from the Net. It also includes features such as CD burning, audio ripping and repair tools, it is capable of handling multiple streams of audio data and can process sound with DAT quality (48 KHz, 16-bit, stereo).

- + Good features
- + Great plugins

**Price:** Rs 19,200 (approx)  
**Web site:** [www.sonicfoundry.com](http://www.sonicfoundry.com)

Worthy Mentions

Cool Edit 2000

- + Unlimited undo levels
- + Great interface
- Price:** Rs 3,312 (approx)
- Web site:** [www.syntrillium.com](http://www.syntrillium.com)

Goldwave

- + Supports a variety of audio formats
- + Small install size
- Price:** Rs 1,920 (approx)
- Web site:** [www.goldwave.com](http://www.goldwave.com)

**PREVIOUS WINNERS** 2000: NA 1999: NA 1998: NA